Listing 6.47 Response from a `_rollover` call

```
{
  "acknowledged" : true,
  "shards_acknowledged" : true,
  "old_index" : "latest_cars-000001",
  "new_index" : "latest_cars-000002",
  "rolled_over" : true,
  "dry_run" : false,
  "conditions" : { }
}
```

Old index name

New index name

As the response indicates, a new index (`latest_cars-000002`) was created as a rollover index. The old index was put into read-only mode to pave the way for indexing documents on the newly created rollover index.

> **NOTE** The rollover API is applied to the alias, but the index behind this alias is the one that is rolled over.

Behind the scenes, invoking the `_rollover` call on the alias does a couple of things:

- Creates a new index (`cars_2021-000002`) with the same configuration as the old one (the name prefix stays the same, but the suffix after the dash is incremented).
- Remaps the alias to point to the new index that was freshly generated (`cars_2021-000002`, in this case). Our queries are unaffected because all queries are written against an alias (not a physical index).
- Deletes the alias on the current index and repoints it to the newly created rollover index.

When we invoke a `_rollover` command, Elasticsearch performs a set of actions (remember, the current index must have an alias pointing to the index as a prerequisite):

- Makes the current index read-only (so only queries are executed)
- Creates a new index with the appropriate naming convention
- Repoints the alias to this new index

If we re-invoke the call in listing 6.47, a new index `cars_2021-000003` is created, and the alias is reassigned to this new index rather than the old `cars_2021-000002` index. When we need to roll over the data to a new index, simply invoking `_rollover` on the alias will suffice.

Naming conventions

Let's touch base with the naming conventions we use when rolling over indexes. The `_rollover` API has two formats—one where we can provide an index name

```
POST <index_alias>/_rollover
```